

ESO/Frames Practice — Daily Protocol

Role: Main Instructor | Track: ESO Discourse Frames | Version 1.0 | Effective: July 27, 2026

1. PURPOSE AND SCOPE

This SOP governs the daily instructional cycle for the ESO Discourse Frames track of the B10 Practice Platform (B10-PP). It applies to all Main Instructors assigned to classes in which students are completing ESO Frames practice as part of ILR 2+/3 oral English proficiency development.

The ESO Frames track is organized around a **6-week repeating cycle**, one discourse frame per week. Each week follows a **5-day arc** that moves students from fully scaffolded attempts on Day 1 toward independent, cold production by Day 5. The weekend bridge assignment at the end of each week consolidates that week's frame while beginning to spiral in previously learned frames.

This document is the primary procedural reference for daily classroom decisions. It is organized by day within the week. Consult Section 5 for the week-specific frame reference.

2. WHAT YOU ARE DOING RIGHT NOW

Identify your current position in the weekly arc and go directly to the corresponding section.

Day	Your Task	Go to Section
Day 1	Orientation (first week only) or launch new frame; assign D1 ESO questions	Section 3.1
Day 2	Debrief D1 attempts; assign D2 ESO questions; introduce spiral (W2+)	Section 3.2
Day 3	Debrief D2 attempts; begin scaffold fading; assign D3 questions	Section 3.3
Day 4	Debrief D3 attempts; student-selected questions; cold/near-cold production	Section 3.4
Day 5	Debrief D4 attempts; assign weekend bridge from ESO bank	Section 3.5

FIRST WEEK ON THIS TRACK

If this is a student's first week on the ESO Frames track — whether that is calendar Week 1 of the course or a later entry point — follow the Day 1 orientation procedure in Section 3.1 and treat this week as a single-frame week with no spiral requirement. The spiral begins in the student's second week on the track, regardless of which frame they started on.

3. DAILY PROCEDURES

Enabling Activities — Daily Frame Practice

Each class session includes a 10–15 minute enabling activity drawn from the current week's Enabling Activities set. Activities follow the weekly arc below, progressing from surface/declarative practice (Activity 1a) toward procedural/automatic transfer (Activity 4c). Repetition across the week is the mechanism by which frames become proceduralized.

Day	Activity	Focus
Day 1	Activity 1a	Depth Ladder — surface, scaffolded
Day 2	Activity 1b	Sentence-Frame Progression
Day 3	Activity 1c	Comparison & Paraphrase
Day 4	Activity 4a	2-Box Induction — pattern recognition
Day 5	Activity 4b or 4c	Silent Protocol or Strategic Competence — transfer

Refer to the current week's Enabling Activities document for full instructions. Adapted from: McDowell, M. (2026, June 30). Rigor redefined [Conference session]. ISTE 2026, Orange County Convention Center.

3.1 Day 1: Frame Launch

FIRST WEEK ON TRACK — ORIENTATION REQUIRED

If this is a student's or class's first week on the ESO Frames track, begin with the B10-PP enrollment and orientation procedure below before proceeding to the frame launch steps. If students are already enrolled and familiar with the platform, skip directly to Step 1.

B10-PP ENROLLMENT AND ORIENTATION (FIRST WEEK ONLY)

(1) Confirm that each student has been added to your roster using their assigned B10-PP ID. Students cannot self-enroll. (2) Direct students to the platform at b10-practice-platform.web.app and have them log in. (3) Instruct students to record their B10-PP ID and password and store them securely. Passwords cannot be reset. (4) The B10-PP ID is the permanent student identifier across all platform tracks. (5) Briefly orient students to the platform interface: passage navigation, the recording screen, and where to find scores and feedback. (6) Direct students to the ESO/Frames section and confirm they can locate the current week's Phrase Reference HTML and the Frames Argument Builder.

1 Introduce the week's discourse frame.

State the frame name and its three-step process (see Section 5 for the current week). Explain what kind of analytical move this frame requires. Keep the introduction to 3–5 minutes. Students develop understanding through practice, not through explanation.

2 Direct students to the week's Phrase Reference HTML.

Students open the current week's reference document in the ESO/Frames section of the platform. This is their primary scaffold for the week. Instruct them to read the frame description and review the sample questions and phrase chunks before attempting any ESO question.

3 Walk through the Frames Argument Builder together.

Open the Frames Argument Builder (available in the Frames Practice section). With the class, work through the three-step sequence for this week's frame using one of the Day 1 ESO questions as a model. Demonstrate the planning process only — identify each step, apply it to the question, stop before recording.

4 Assign Day 1 ESO questions (1–2 questions).

Assign 1–2 questions from the current week's ESO folder — select the most accessible questions in the set. Students complete these at home tonight. Full scaffold is in effect: the Phrase Reference HTML and Frames Argument Builder are open during planning. Students plan mentally using the three-step process. They do not write out their response before recording.

5 Set expectations for tomorrow's debrief.

Inform students that a strong response from tonight's attempt will be played and discussed tomorrow. Students willing to share should note this — or the instructor will select from submissions.

1 Confirm D1 submissions via instructor dashboard.

Verify submissions received. Note non-submitting students — follow up privately.

2 Select a D1 exemplar response (Option A — Instructor-Selected).

Identify a 3/4 or 4/4 response from last night's attempts. Select one that clearly engages all three steps of this week's frame. Read the ESO question aloud, then play the student's recorded response audio to the class.

INSTRUCTOR DISCRETION — OPTION B (VOLUNTEER)

As an alternative or on a subsequent day, invite a student volunteer to share. Option B surfaces a range including responses with productive gaps. Most effective after the class has a calibration reference from Option A. Consider alternating across the week.

3 Display and discuss the transcript.

After playing the student response audio, lead discussion: (1) Which of the three frame steps are clearly present? (2) Where is the middle step most visible? Where is it missing or thin? (3) What specific language carried the argument at each step? (4) What would move this response from a 3 to a 4?

4 Introduce the spiral requirement (Week 2+ only).

Beginning in a student's second week on the track, students are expected to incorporate 1–2 prior frames alongside the current week's frame — 2–3 total active frames per response. A response that makes no attempt to integrate prior frames does not meet the standard for that week. Name the relevant prior frames to draw on (see Section 5).

5 Assign Day 2 ESO questions (2 questions).

Assign 2 questions from the current week's ESO folder of moderate difficulty. Full scaffold remains in effect. Remind students of the spiral requirement if applicable.

1 Confirm D2 submissions and debrief.

Follow the debrief procedure from Day 2, Steps 1–3. On Day 3, prioritize Option B (volunteer) if the class has not yet had a student-led debrief — students are now calibrated enough to evaluate each other's responses productively.

2 Introduce scaffold fading.

Explain to students that beginning tonight, the Phrase Reference HTML remains available as a reference but students should attempt to plan mentally before consulting it. The three-step sequence should now be internalized enough to apply without reading it line by line. Use the reference to confirm or recover, not to initiate.

3 Assign Day 3 ESO questions (1–2 questions).

Assign 1–2 questions of increasing difficulty from the weekly folder. Scaffold is fading: the Phrase Reference HTML is available but students plan mentally first. No written outline before recording.

4 Reinforce spiral explicitly. [*Spiral — Week 2+*]

Remind students that prior frames must appear in tonight's responses. Name the specific frames. A useful prompt: *"Before you record, identify which prior frame is most naturally activated by this question — then build it in."*

1 Confirm D3 submissions and debrief.

Follow the debrief procedure. On Day 4, focus discussion on spiral integration quality — not just whether prior frames appeared, but whether they were woven organically into the argument or felt appended.

2 Move to cold production.

Inform students that tonight's attempt is cold or near-cold: the Phrase Reference HTML is available only as a last resort. Students plan mentally — working through the frame's three steps and identifying relevant prior frames — before recording. No written notes, no open reference during planning.

3 Students select their own question(s) from the weekly folder.

Students choose 1–2 questions from the remaining questions in the current week's ESO folder. Attempting more than one question tonight is encouraged — this is the highest-volume production night of the week.

4 Reinforce spiral — cold integration. [*Spiral — Week 2+*]

Students are expected to integrate prior frames without prompting. Remind them: the planning pause before recording is the moment to select 1–2 prior frames the question most naturally activates and to decide how to sequence them. Three frames total — current week plus 1–2 prior — is the ceiling, not the floor.

1 Confirm D4 submissions and debrief.

Follow the debrief procedure. On Day 5, focus on cold production quality: did students demonstrate internalized frame structure without scaffolding? Did spiral frames appear organically? Select or solicit a response that illustrates both.

2 Assign the weekend bridge question.

Select one question from the general ESO bank — not from the current week's weekly folder. The question should be domain-appropriate and at ILR 3 difficulty. See Section 5 for a suggested weekend bridge question per week.

3 Assign the combo scaffold for the weekend bridge.

The weekend bridge always uses a two-frame scaffold combination: the current week's frame + one prior frame. State both frames explicitly. Instruct students to plan using both frame sequences from the Frames Argument Builder — the current week's frame as primary, the prior frame woven in. See Section 5 for the recommended scaffold combo per week.

4 Brief students on the weekend bridge purpose.

The weekend bridge is the first step in proceduralization. Students are not just practicing this week's frame — they are beginning to deploy frames in combination, which is what ILR 3 ESO production requires. Encountering an unfamiliar question from the general bank with a multi-frame scaffold is the closest simulation of actual test conditions this track provides.

4. THE WEEKLY ARC AT A GLANCE

Day	Scaffold Level	Questions	Source	Spiral
D1	Full — HTML + Argument Builder open	1–2 (most accessible)	Weekly folder	No (first week) / Yes (W2+)
D2	Full	2 (moderate)	Weekly folder	Yes (W2+)
D3	Fading — plan mentally; HTML to confirm	1–2 (increasing)	Weekly folder	Yes (W2+)
D4	Cold — HTML last resort only	Student selects 1–2; may attempt more	Weekly folder	Yes (W2+)
D5 (weekend)	Combo scaffold — current + 1 prior frame	1	General ESO bank	Yes — built into scaffold

ON THE SPIRAL — FUNDAMENTAL PRINCIPLE

Spiraling is not enrichment. It is the mechanism by which frames become proceduralized — available for deployment in any ESO context without conscious retrieval effort. A student in Week 4 who responds only with the Hypothetical & Conditional frame has not met the standard for that week. Students are expected to incorporate 1–2 prior frames alongside the current week's frame — 2–3 frames total per response. The goal is not exhaustiveness but selection: students choose the prior frames most naturally activated by the question and deploy them as integrated analytical moves, not as afterthoughts appended at the end.

5. WEEK-BY-WEEK FRAME REFERENCE

Each section below is self-contained for that week. It includes the three-step frame process, a sample ESO question from the weekly folder, the spiral requirement, and the recommended weekend bridge assignment.

WEEK 1 — Scale & Stakeholder

Stakeholder

Who is affected and at what level?

Impact

What specifically happens to them?

Scale Consideration

Why does operating at that level change the argument?

Key requirement: every response this week engages at least two scale levels (Individual & Family · Organizational & Community · National & Global). A response that stays at one scale level does not meet the standard for this frame.

Sample ESO Question — Weekly Folder

"Should companies be required to provide childcare for employees?"

Spiral requirement: None — this is the first frame. Students focus exclusively on Scale & Stakeholder this week.

Weekend bridge: Assign one question from the general ESO bank. Scaffold: Scale & Stakeholder only (no combo required for Week 1). Example: "Should governments prioritize economic growth over environmental protection?"

WEEK 2 — Trade-offs & Constraints

Benefit

What does the policy achieve?

Trade-off

What competing good is sacrificed?

Constraint

Why can't the trade-off simply be avoided?

Key requirement: naming a trade-off is insufficient — students must explain why the competing good cannot simply be preserved alongside the benefit. The constraint is structural, not incidental.

Sample ESO Question — Weekly Folder

"Should governments fund the arts during periods of economic austerity?"

Spiral requirement: Scale & Stakeholder (W1). Students identify who bears the trade-off and at what scale — this activates the W1 frame naturally within a trade-offs analysis.

Weekend bridge: General ESO bank. Combo scaffold: Trade-offs & Constraints (primary) + Scale & Stakeholder (secondary). Example: "Should foreign investment in farmland be restricted?"

WEEK 3 — Causal Systems

Trigger

What sets the causal chain in motion?

Mechanism

How does the effect actually get produced?

Downstream Effect

What results at the end of the chain?

Key requirement: the mechanism step is the analytical core. Students who jump from trigger to downstream effect without explaining the process by which the effect is produced are operating at ILR 2+, not ILR 3. The mechanism must be explicit.

Sample ESO Question — Weekly Folder

"Should governments regulate the use of artificial intelligence in hiring decisions?"

Spiral requirement: Draw on 1–2 prior frames (W1 and/or W2) as the question activates them. The causal chain naturally invites stakeholder identification (W1) and often surfaces a trade-off within the mechanism (W2). Students select whichever prior frame fits most organically — total active frames: 2–3.

Weekend bridge: General ESO bank. Combo scaffold: Causal Systems (primary) + Trade-offs & Constraints (secondary). Example: "Should countries ban single-use plastics?"

WEEK 4 — Hypothetical & Conditional

Condition

What must hold for this scenario to follow?

Projected Outcome

What would likely result?

Extended Scenario

And if that outcome holds, then what?

Key requirement: the extended scenario step requires students to project beyond the immediate outcome — to reason one step further. A response that stops at the projected outcome is a two-step response, not a three-step one.

Sample ESO Question — Weekly Folder

"Should universities eliminate standardized testing as an admissions requirement?"

Spiral requirement: Draw on 1–2 prior frames (W1, W2, or W3) as the question activates them. A strong response typically anchors the condition in specific stakeholders (W1) or names the trade-off embedded in the projected outcome (W2). Total active frames: 2–3.

Weekend bridge: General ESO bank. Combo scaffold: Hypothetical & Conditional (primary) + Causal Systems (secondary). Example: "Should governments provide a universal basic income?"

WEEK 5 — Values, Heuristics & Bias

Value

What does this stakeholder believe is important?

Assumption

What must be true for that value to justify their position?

Competing Framework

What does a stakeholder on the other side believe instead?

Key requirement: the assumption step is the analytical hinge. Naming a value is easy; identifying what must be empirically or normatively true for that value to justify the specific position taken is the ILR 3 move. Students must make the assumption explicit, not implied.

Sample ESO Question — Weekly Folder

"Should social media platforms be held legally responsible for content posted by users?"

Spiral requirement: All prior frames (W1–W4). The values analysis should be grounded in specific stakeholders (W1), name the trade-off between competing values (W2), trace the causal mechanism by which a value produces a policy position (W3), and frame the competing value as a conditional (W4).

Weekend bridge: General ESO bank. Combo scaffold: Values, Heuristics & Bias (primary) + Scale & Stakeholder (secondary). Example: "Should wealthy nations accept more refugees?"

WEEK 6 — Synthesis & Judgment

Tensions

What competing claims must be addressed?

Priorities

Which consideration carries more weight and why?

Judgment

What is the most defensible conclusion?

Key requirement: Week 6 is the integration frame — it does not replace prior frames, it organizes them. Tensions are named using prior frames. Priorities are argued, not asserted. The judgment is the most defensible conclusion given the tensions named — not a restatement of position.

Sample ESO Question — Weekly Folder

"Should governments prioritize national security over individual privacy rights?"

Spiral requirement: Draw on 1–2 prior frames (W1–W5) as the question activates them. The tensions named in Step 1 should be articulated using the analytical vocabulary of prior frames. Students select the 1–2 prior frames that most sharpen the tension being named. Total active frames: 2–3. W6 is the frame in which spiral selection quality is most visible and most assessable.

Weekend bridge: General ESO bank. Combo scaffold: Synthesis & Judgment (primary) + any two prior frames student selects. This is the first week students choose their own spiral combination. Example: "Should countries be required to contribute to a global climate fund?"

6. STUDENT PRE-RECORDING PROTOCOL

Share this protocol with students at the start of the track. It describes the student-facing procedure for every ESO Frames attempt.

- 1 Open the current week's Phrase Reference HTML.**
Locate it in the ESO/Frames section of the platform under the current week's folder.
- 2 Read the ESO question carefully.**
Do not begin planning until you have read the full question and understood what position or analysis it requires.
- 3 Work through the three-step frame process mentally.**
Use the Frames Argument Builder sequence for this week. Identify your answer to each step. Do not write your response out.
- 4 Identify your spiral frames (Week 2+).**
Identify 1–2 prior frames most naturally activated by this question. Decide where they will appear — woven into the argument, not appended at the end. You are targeting 2–3 total active frames per response.
- 5 Record.**
Speak from your mental plan. If you lose your place, use the frame steps as recovery anchors — return to the step you were on and continue.

7. SCORING REFERENCE

ESO Frames responses are scored 1–4. The platform score is holistic. For debrief purposes, orient discussion around the following descriptors.

Score	What It Reflects
4 / 4	All three frame steps clearly present and developed; middle step analytical and explicit; spiral frames integrated organically (W2+); argument coherent and well-supported
3 / 4	Frame structure present; middle step present but may be underdeveloped; spiral frames present but may feel appended rather than integrated; language adequate
2 / 4	Frame partially applied; middle step thin or missing; spiral absent or nominal; argument incomplete or loses coherence
1 / 4	Frame not identifiable in response; argument absent or significantly distorted; language significantly limits communication

INSTRUCTOR NOTE

Do not share score descriptors directly with students as a rubric. Use them to guide your selection of exemplar responses and to frame debrief discussion. Scaffold feedback on the platform is diagnostic — the score is always holistic.

8. ADMINISTRATIVE NOTES

- **Dashboard access:** b10-practice-platform.web.app — log in with your assigned B10-PP instructor ID.
- **Submission window:** Student audio is retained for 72 hours. Plan debriefs within this window.
- **Non-submitting students:** Follow up privately. Do not delay the class debrief.
- **8-question limit per weekly folder:** Each weekly ESO folder contains 8 questions. The pacing in this SOP distributes questions across the week without exhausting the folder. The weekend bridge always draws from the general ESO bank.
- **Score visibility:** Students see scores immediately after submission. Your debrief adds interpretive value — it does not gate scores.
- **Cycle reset:** After Week 6, the cycle repeats from Week 1. Students entering the second cycle carry full spiral knowledge — all six frames are active from Day 1 of the repeat cycle.